

1. Does trust in a nonprofit brand predict donor commitment and loyalty?

2. How does perceived integrity affect trust in nonprofit organizations?
3. Is brand trust a mediator between brand equity and donation intention in nonprofits?
4. Does organizational commitment predict prosocial behavior toward nonprofits?
5. How does nonprofit transparency affect donor trust and giving behavior?
6. What is the relationship between brand commitment and donor retention in nonprofits?

Yes, **trust, commitment, and transparency** are linked to **donation support** in nonprofits, though mediation evidence is narrower.

The six questions cluster into **trust and loyalty**, **integrity and transparency**, and **mediation and prosocial outcomes**.

Trust and Loyalty

Trust in a nonprofit brand generally predicts stronger donor commitment and support intentions, but direct evidence on long-term behavioral loyalty is still thinner than evidence on attitudes and intentions (Millán et al., 2023; Kutlu & Özcan, 2024).

- **Trust predicts intention** to donate in nonprofit samples (Kutlu & Özcan, 2024; Ha et al., 2022).
- Brand trust is treated as a **core equity dimension** alongside awareness and commitment in nonprofit brand equity models (Romero & Abril, 2023; Hommerová et al., 2025).
- Commitment is usually the more relevant **loyalty analogue** in nonprofits because donors often support multiple organizations, so attitudinal and emotional attachment matter more than exclusive repeat behavior (Romero et al., 2023).

Integrity and Transparency

Perceived integrity appears to build trust because donors use moral and accountability cues to judge nonprofits they cannot directly monitor (Venable et al., 2005; Romero & Abril, 2023). Transparency works similarly by reducing uncertainty about how donations are used, although most evidence is cross-sectional.

- In nonprofit brand personality research, **integrity and reliability** emerged as central trust-related traits (Venable et al., 2005).
- Perceived financial transparency is positively associated with **donor trust** and perceived nonprofit performance (Ghoorah et al., 2025).
- Donors want clearer information on **use of contributions**, and communication about how donations help people in need explains substantial variance in trust and commitment (Hommerová et al., 2025; O'Neil, 2009).

Mediation and Prosocial Outcomes

Brand trust does mediate some paths to donation intention, but the evidence is for specific upstream brand constructs rather than a single unified “brand equity → trust → donation” pathway (Kutlu & Özcan, 2024; Ha et al., 2022). Organizational commitment also aligns with broader prosocial support, including retention, advocacy, and additional giving.

- Brand trust **partially mediates** the effect of brand heritage on donation intention (Kutlu & Özcan, 2024).
- Brand trust and familiarity mediate the effect of **brand anthropomorphism** on charity support intention (Ha et al., 2022).
- Stronger brand-related attachment predicts **retention and extra-role support**: brand strength increased 1-year and 5-year volunteer retention intentions, donation intentions, bequest intentions, recruitment intentions, and word of mouth, with donation and bequest effects partly mediated by transparency (Wymer & Čačija, 2025).

Key Comparisons

Question	Best-supported answer	Main caveat
Trust → commitment or loyalty	Yes, especially for commitment and donation intention (Millán et al., 2023; Sargeant et al., 2006)	Loyalty is often attitudinal, not exclusive repeat giving
Integrity → trust	Yes, integrity is a central trust cue (Venable et al., 2005; Anshori et al., 2022)	Usually inferred from perceptions, not audited conduct
Trust as mediator	Yes, in specific models (Kutlu & Özcan, 2024; Ha et al., 2022)	Few studies test full brand equity mediation
Transparency → giving	Appears positive through trust and confidence (Ghoorah et al., 2025; , 2025)	Mostly observational evidence

FIGURE 1 How trust, integrity, commitment, and transparency relate to nonprofit donor behavior.

Overall, **trust in a nonprofit brand does predict donor commitment-related outcomes**, integrity and transparency help build that trust, and trust sometimes mediates donation intention, but direct evidence on donor retention remains more limited than evidence on intention, commitment, and broader supportive behavior.

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